

Acknowledgements

We hit upon the idea for *Coffee Can Investing: The Low-Risk Road to Stupendous Wealth* when Saurabh was at the CNBC studio in August 2016. He was recording the second episode of a six-part programme that CNBC had come up with around Saurabh's bestselling book *The Unusual Billionaires*. Saurabh and Latha Venkatesh, the CNBC anchor, were waiting for Jalaj Dani, then at Asian Paints, to join the show. Dwelling on the contents of *The Unusual Billionaires*, Latha happened to remark that 'it has become harder to identify good mutual funds than it is to identify good stocks'. When Saurabh came back to the office and relayed the remark to us, we wondered that if well-informed market observers found it difficult to figure out how to invest in the stock market, then what hope did the average investor have. Given the existential pressures bearing down on people, can they really navigate the maze of data, regulations and distorted incentives that characterize investing in India? For giving us the germ of the idea that went on to become this book, we are thankful to Latha Venkatesh.

We believe most people do *not* invest to make a lot of money. They invest to meet goals like paying for their children's education and funding their retirement. They also invest to fulfil their dreams, which might be as modest as buying a nice TV or as grand as owning a resort in the Himalayas. Whilst we had long believed in the centrality of goals and dreams in the investment process, it wasn't until we came across Ashvin B. Chhabra's superb book, *The Aspirational Investor: Investing in the Pursuit of Wealth and Happiness*¹ (2015), that we found a structured way to link life goals with asset allocation. We owe an intellectual debt to Ashvin Chhabra and hope that he continues to write in a similar vein.